# Example Outline

(from a different Paper 2 assignment - don't model the thesis; this is just so you can see the expected format)

**Thesis:** This paper argues that the authors' theory conflates the management of fear with the enjoyment of fear without clarifying the connection between them, and therefore fails to explain what specifically becomes enjoyable in the process of playing horror games.

1. To assess the potential limitations of Kjeldgaard-Christiansen and Clasen's theory, it is first necessary to understand how they explain the appeal of horror games.
2. However, while Kjeldgaard-Christiansen and Clasen argue that horror games enable players to overcome fear-based challenges, they do not explain how this process gives rise to emotional enjoyment.
3. Firstly, while Kjeldgaard-Christiansen and Clasen argue that horror games are appealing because they allow players to engage with fear through structured, goal-oriented gameplay, the widespread popularity of non-interactive horror forms – films, haunted houses, novels – suggests that fear can be emotionally compelling even without mastery or coping, highlighting a key ambiguity in the authors' explanation of what exactly leads to enjoyment.
4. To support the idea that fear may be appealing in and of itself, even without the possibility of mastery or control, existing research from fellow evolutionary psychologists offers compelling evidence.
5. Empirical research further supports the idea that fear can be enjoyable in passive, uncontrollable situations.
6. When applied to horror games, the above findings imply that players may be drawn to the emotional intensity of fear itself, rather than the satisfaction of overcoming fear-based challenges.
7. A possible way to refine their theory is to distinguish between two types of mastery.
8. Secondly, while Kjeldgaard-Christiansen and Clasen argue that the appeal of horror games lies in the player's ability to master fear-based scenarios through structured gameplay, their explanation becomes less precise when considering that similar goal-driven structures in non-horror games also produce enjoyment.
9. Research from motivational and evolutionary psychology supports the idea that structured gameplay is intrinsically rewarding even without fear-based content.
10. Along the same vein, Uysal and Yildirim (2016) demonstrate that intrinsic enjoyment in digital games often emerges from the satisfaction of basic psychological needs, independent of thematic content.

11. Overall, these perspectives suggest that the enjoyment of horror games might stem less from their content and more from the structural elements they share with other genres.

**Significance:** Treating coping with fear and enjoying fear as interchangeable obscures an important distinction between interactive media, like videogames, and non-interactive media, like film. The ability to manage fear through gameplay is unique to interactive media, but the capacity of fear itself to be pleasurable is something interactive media shares with non-interactive media.

Note:

- Don't highlight any sentences prior to the thesis in the paper or include them in the outline
- Include at most 2 sentences per item
- The significance statement should be 1-2 sentences from your conclusion that captures why your argument matters beyond the specific disagreement you analyzed
- I will begin my feedback based on the outline, so make sure the topic sentences capture the arguments you most want feedback about